"Needing medication means I'm weak."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Some grew up hearing that real strength means toughing things out. Taking medicine for pain, blood pressure, diabetes, depression, or anxiety can then feel like failure of will. Shame keeps some from starting or from being honest with their doctor.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, "It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick." Paul told Timothy to "use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments" (1 Timothy 5:23). Luke, "the beloved physician," traveled with Paul (Colossians 4:14). The good Samaritan treated wounds with oil and wine. God often uses doctors and medicines as His means of care. Strength is not refusing help. Wisdom is using the gifts God provides.

> *"Jesus answered, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"* (Luke 5:31).

Also see

> "Stop drinking only water and use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments" (1 Timothy 5:23).

> "Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings" (Colossians 4:14).

> "The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel" (Proverbs 12:15).

> "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds" (Psalm 147:3).

Common self-statements

- Strong people do not need pills.
- I should be able to handle this myself.
- Medication is a crutch.
- I am giving in.
- I have failed.
- Others manage without it.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either strong and drug-free or weak.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will depend on it forever.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that I am weak.
- Labeling: Calling myself weak.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn that needing medicine is weak?
- Would I say the same to someone with a heart condition or diabetes?
- What would my life be like without this treatment?
- What does Scripture say about doctors and remedies?

- What do I fear about taking it?
- What questions should I ask my doctor?

Truth summary

> Medicine is one of God's ways of caring for His people. Using it wisely, with my doctor's guidance, is not weakness. It is stewardship of the body God gave me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Therapy
- Weakness
- Pride
- Humility
- Wisdom

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Needing medication means I'm weak"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Needing medication means I'm weak." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn that needing medicine is weak?
- ☐ Would I say the same to someone with a heart condition or diabetes?
- ☐ What would my life be like without this treatment?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about doctors and remedies?
- ☐ What do I fear about taking it?
- ☐ What questions should I ask my doctor?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The sick need a doctor.
- ☐ God uses doctors and remedies.
- ☐ Wise people take counsel.
- ☐ Stewarding my body is wise.
- ☐ Taking medicine is not failure.
- ☐ I can ask my doctor questions.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Luke 5:31
  "Jesus answered, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"
- ☐ 1 Timothy 5:23
  "Stop drinking only water and use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments."
- ☐ Colossians 4:14
  "Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Wise care: Each week, note one way you followed through on care.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 5:31 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The sick need a doctor, and there is no shame in that.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Therapy" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Write your fears. List what worries you about medication.
- [ ] Ask your doctor. Bring questions to the next visit.
- [ ] Take as prescribed. Do not stop suddenly without medical advice.
- [ ] Read Luke 5:31. Remember the sick need a doctor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Needing medication means I'm weak": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Wise care
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Needing medication means I'm weak.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, thank You for doctors and medicine. Free me from shame, and help me use these gifts wisely and faithfully. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #12 · MEDICATIONS AND TREATMENT

“If this treatment didn't work, nothing will.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

After a treatment fails, hope takes a hit. Repeated disappointment trains us to expect failure and to stop trying. Fatigue and cost add to the temptation to quit.

What Scripture teaches

Peter and his friends had fished all night and caught nothing. Jesus said, “Put out into deep water, and let down your nets for a catch,” and Peter said, “Because You say so, I will let down the nets” (Luke 5:4–5). Scripture encourages persistence: “Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up” (Galatians 6:9). One failed treatment does not mean all will fail, and God’s purposes are bigger than any plan.

> *“Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up”* (Galatians 6:9).

Also see

> “When Jesus had finished speaking, He said to Simon, ‘Put out into deep water and let down your nets for a catch.’ ‘Master,’ Simon replied, ‘we have worked hard all night without catching anything. But because You say so, I will let down the nets.’” (Luke 5:4–5).

> “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed” (Proverbs 15:22).

> “But those who wait upon the LORD will renew their strength; they will mount up with wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary, they will walk and not faint” (Isaiah 40:31).

> “Rest in God alone, O my soul, for my hope comes from Him” (Psalm 62:5).

Common self-statements

- It did not work, so nothing will.
- I am a hopeless case.
- Why try again?
- I am wasting time and money.
- There is nothing left.
- I am tired of being disappointed.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing a treatment either works or nothing will.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that all options will fail.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling disappointed and concluding there is no hope.
- Overgeneralizing: Calling myself untreatable.

Challenging questions

- What exactly did not work, and what did we learn from it?
- What other options might exist?

- What does my doctor say about next steps?
- What encouraged me before?
- How do I care for my heart after disappointment?
- Who can support me through the next try?

Truth summary

> One failed treatment is one failed treatment. I can grieve the disappointment, ask my doctor about other options, and keep trusting God, who is with me whether or not the next step works.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Sickness
- Faith
- Wisdom
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If this treatment didn't work, nothing will"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If this treatment didn't work, nothing will." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly did not work, and what did we learn from it?
- ☐ What other options might exist?
- ☐ What does my doctor say about next steps?
- ☐ What encouraged me before?
- ☐ How do I care for my heart after disappointment?
- ☐ Who can support me through the next try?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Failure of one is not failure of all.
- ☐ I will not grow weary.
- ☐ I can ask my doctor about next steps.
- ☐ God is my hope.
- ☐ I do not despise small beginnings.
- ☐ God is with me either way.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:9
  "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up."
- ☐ Luke 5:4–5
  "When Jesus had finished speaking, He said to Simon, 'Put out into deep water and let down your nets for a catch.' 'Master,' Simon replied, 'we have worked hard all night without catching anything. But because You say so, I will let down the nets.'"
- ☐ Proverbs 15:22
  "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Another step: Each week, note one step you took toward the next option.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Galatians 6:9 becomes: "Sarah can write: "At the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Review with your doctor. Ask for other options.
- ☐ Seek a second opinion. Consider another specialist.
- ☐ Rest. Take time to recover from disappointment.
- ☐ Pray Psalm 62:5. Wait on God alone.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If this treatment didn't work, nothing will": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Another step
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If this treatment didn't work, nothing will.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am discouraged by treatment that did not work. Give me courage, wisdom about next steps, and hope in You. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #13 · MEDICATIONS AND TREATMENT

"I'll have to take this forever, so I'll never really be well."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Long-term medication for chronic conditions can feel like a life sentence. We equate "well" with "needing nothing," and so we feel permanently broken even when we are doing well.

What Scripture teaches

The apostle Paul prayed three times for his thorn to be removed. Instead, God said, "My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness." People can live full, productive lives while managing a condition. David wrote, "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made." Wellness is not the absence of need but the presence of care, purpose, and peace. Needing daily help is one way to depend daily on God's provision.

> *"But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me"* (2 Corinthians 12:9).

Also see

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "Bless the LORD, O my soul, and do not forget all His kind deeds— He who forgives all your iniquities and heals all your diseases" (Psalm 103:2–3).

> "I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need. I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength" (Philippians 4:12–13).

> "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!" (Lamentations 3:22–23).

Common self-statements

- I will always be a patient.
- I will never be normal.
- I am permanently unwell.
- Being on medication means I am sick.
- I cannot ever stop.
- This is a life sentence.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either medication-free and well or sick.
- Fortune telling: Predicting permanent dependence.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling burdened and concluding I am never well.
- Labeling: Calling myself chronically ill.

Challenging questions

- What does “well” mean to me?
- What parts of my life are going well because of this treatment?
- Who do I know who lives fully with a long-term condition?
- How could I see my medication as a daily provision?
- What does Scripture say about grace in weakness?
- What would help me feel more at peace with daily treatment?

Truth summary

> I can live well while managing a condition. Daily care is a provision and a reminder of God’s daily grace, not a sign that I am broken beyond hope.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Sickness
- Thankful
- Weakness
- Trust
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God’s perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God’s steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ’s resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

My Plan for Replacing "I'll have to take this forever, so I'll never really be well"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll have to take this forever, so I'll never really be well." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does "well" mean to me?
- ☐ What parts of my life are going well because of this treatment?
- ☐ Who do I know who lives fully with a long-term condition?
- ☐ How could I see my medication as a daily provision?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about grace in weakness?
- ☐ What would help me feel more at peace with daily treatment?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's grace is sufficient.
- ☐ His power is perfected in weakness.
- ☐ I can live a full life with care.
- ☐ Needing help is not failure.
- ☐ Each day I can thank God for provision.
- ☐ Wellness includes peace.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."
- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ Psalm 103:2–3
  "Bless the LORD, O my soul, and do not forget all His kind deeds— He who forgives all your iniquities and heals all your diseases."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Well in many ways: Each week, note three ways you are doing well.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 12:9 becomes: "Sarah can write: "His grace is sufficient for me each day.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Thankful" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Redefine well. Write what a good day looks like.
- [ ] Build a routine. Link medication to a daily habit.
- [ ] Thank God daily. Pair your dose with a short prayer.
- [ ] Talk to your doctor. Ask about long-term outlook and adjustments.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll have to take this forever, so I'll never really be well": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Well in many ways
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll have to take this forever, so I'll never really be well.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am tired of daily medicine. Teach me to receive it as Your provision, and help me live fully and gratefully each day. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“Taking medication means I'm not really myself.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Some medicines change mood, energy, or thinking. Some people feel flattened or foggy, and others worry that treatment changes their personality or covers their “real” feelings. Fear of losing oneself makes people stop treatment on their own.

What Scripture teaches

God knows who you are: “O LORD, You have searched me and known me” (Psalm 139:1). Your identity is not a chemical state. It is rooted in being made by God and belonging to Him. Paul says, “Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day.” Treatment that helps your brain or body function better can free the real you, not erase you. If you feel different in a worrying way, tell your doctor. Do not stop on your own.

> *“O LORD, You have searched me and known me”* (Psalm 139:1).

Also see

> “For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:13–14).

> “Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day” (2 Corinthians 4:16).

> “Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: ‘Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!’” (Isaiah 43:1).

> “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed” (Proverbs 15:22).

Common self-statements

- I am not me on this medicine.
- It is changing who I am.
- My real self is gone.
- I feel numb.
- I am fake.
- I would rather feel pain than lose myself.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either fully myself or altered.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will lose my identity.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling different and concluding that I am not myself.
- Labeling: Calling myself fake.

Challenging questions

- What exactly feels different, and when did it start?
- Was I more myself before, or was I in pain or fog?
- What do family and friends notice?

- What do I want my doctor to know?
- What helps me feel like me?
- What does it mean that God knows my true self?

Truth summary

> God knows me completely, and my identity does not rest on how I feel at the moment. If treatment is dulling me, my doctor can adjust it. I can seek the real me with care and honesty.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Therapy
- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, All Knowing
- Wisdom
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Taking medication means I'm not really myself"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Taking medication means I'm not really myself." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly feels different, and when did it start?
- ☐ Was I more myself before, or was I in pain or fog?
- ☐ What do family and friends notice?
- ☐ What do I want my doctor to know?
- ☐ What helps me feel like me?
- ☐ What does it mean that God knows my true self?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God knows me.
- ☐ My identity is in Him.
- ☐ My inner self is being renewed.
- ☐ I can tell my doctor what I feel.
- ☐ Adjustments are possible.
- ☐ I am still me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 139:1
  "O LORD, You have searched me and known me."
- ☐ Psalm 139:13–14
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Still me: Each week, note one thing that felt like you.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 139:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God knows me, and my identity rests in Him.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Therapy" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Track how you feel. Note mood, energy, and clarity.
- [ ] Tell your doctor. Report side effects or changes honestly.
- [ ] Ask a trusted person. Ask how they see you.
- [ ] Do not stop abruptly. Make changes only with your doctor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Taking medication means I'm not really myself": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Still me
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Taking medication means I'm not really myself.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You know the real me. Guide my doctors, give me honesty, and help me live as Your child, whatever my treatment. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #15 · MEDICATIONS AND TREATMENT

“The side effects prove nothing will ever work for me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Nausea, drowsiness, weight change, or other effects can make us want to quit. After a bad experience with one medication, we may assume all treatments will fail or be intolerable.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture counsels wisdom and counsel: “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed.” “Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.” Side effects are real and deserve a doctor’s attention. They do not mean that no option exists. Doctors can often adjust dose, timing, or type. God works through persistent, honest conversation and wise adjustments.

> *“Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed”* (Proverbs 15:22).

Also see

> “Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up” (Galatians 6:9).

> “The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel” (Proverbs 12:15).

> “I lift up my eyes to the hills. From where does my help come? My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth” (Psalm 121:1–2).

> “But those who wait upon the LORD will renew their strength; they will mount up with wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary, they will walk and not faint” (Isaiah 40:31).

Common self-statements

- This is intolerable.
- Nothing agrees with me.
- I will never find something that works.
- The cure is worse than the illness.
- I am too sensitive.
- I should give up.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing a treatment is either perfect or useless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no medicine will work.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling sick and concluding that nothing can help.
- Overgeneralizing: Calling myself impossible to treat.

Challenging questions

- What exactly are the side effects, and how bad are they?
- Have I told my doctor or pharmacist?
- What adjustments or alternatives exist?
- How long did I give it, and what did the doctor advise?

- What would help me cope with side effects in the meantime?
- Who can help me track what happens?

Truth summary

> Side effects are real and worth addressing, but they do not prove that nothing will work. I can talk with my doctor, adjust or switch under supervision, and keep trusting God for wisdom.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Sickness
- Wisdom
- Therapy
- Hopeless
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "The side effects prove nothing will ever work for me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"The side effects prove nothing will ever work for me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly are the side effects, and how bad are they?
- ☐ Have I told my doctor or pharmacist?
- ☐ What adjustments or alternatives exist?
- ☐ How long did I give it, and what did the doctor advise?
- ☐ What would help me cope with side effects in the meantime?
- ☐ Who can help me track what happens?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Plans succeed with many advisers.
- ☐ I can keep seeking.
- ☐ I will not give up.
- ☐ My doctor can adjust.
- ☐ God helps me.
- ☐ There may be other options.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 15:22**
  "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed."
- ☐ **Galatians 6:9**
  "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up."
- ☐ **Proverbs 12:15**
  "The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

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PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Working it out: Each week, note one conversation with your care team and its result.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 15:22 becomes: "Sarah can write: "With many advisers, plans succeed.""
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Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Log side effects. Write what happens and when.
- [ ] Call your doctor. Report them promptly.
- [ ] Ask about alternatives. Request options.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 121:1–2. Look to the Lord for help.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "The side effects prove nothing will ever work for me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~The side effects prove nothing will ever work for me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, this treatment is hard on me. Give wisdom to my doctors, patience to me, and hope that there is a path forward. Amen.

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